

Read-Only Discovery Session Report Template

Public-safe portfolio evidence generated from sanitized source material.

Purpose

This template shows how I structure a read-only discovery handoff when the goal is to understand reporting assets, dependencies, refresh health, and immediate risks without changing production systems.

Session Metadata

- Discovery type: Reporting readiness review.
- Access posture: Read-only.
- Output audience: Analysts, engineers, and project owners.
- Source systems: Generic operational data platform and BI service.

Discovery Checklist

1. Confirm the target reporting asset and intended business owner.
2. Inventory upstream source objects and serving-layer views.
3. Review refresh cadence, recent run status, and known delays.
4. Check row counts, latest data date, and key coverage.
5. Record open risks, owner follow-ups, and recommended next actions.

Query Audit Fields

Each discovery query should capture:

- Query label.
- System or endpoint type.
- Read-only command or API category.
- Runtime status.
- Row count or finding count.
- Notes needed for follow-up.

Example Findings

Area	Finding	Recommended Action
Serving layer	Reporting view exists and returns current rows	Keep as approved endpoint
Refresh	BI refresh should run after upstream load window	Align schedule and monitor first run
Data quality	Small number of missing account labels	Review source mapping and document exception
Ownership	Support path was not explicit	Add owner and escalation notes to runbook

Handoff Summary

The final handoff should make clear what is ready, what still needs review, and which validation checks can be rerun before a report is published or changed.

What This Demonstrates

- Read-only discovery discipline.
- Repeatable reporting-support workflow.
- Evidence capture for technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- Privacy-conscious reporting documentation.